



levelUp

A COLLECTION OF PRO TIPS FOR EVERYTHING. Without being limited to a particular topic, these tips are from popular software, to coding, to browsers, search, storage rules, password rules, mobile device hacks, bios cracking, tweaks explained and everything tech under the sun.

Router QoS Settings

Take control of your internet connection with these tips about Router QoS

WERE YOU EVER IN A SITUATION

where you almost pulled your hair out in anger because of a sudden unexpected drop in your Internet speed even after having a decent connection? Most people don't realise the fact that it's not the ISPs (Internet Service Providers)

network to provide preferential delivery or better service to selected network traffic by ensuring bandwidth, controlling latency and more.

WHY IS QOS NEEDED?

When QoS is disabled in your router's settings, bandwidth is utilised by everything

bandwidth between both the services. All the while, there is nothing separating the two services in terms of which service should have priority over the other service with respect to the utilisation of available bandwidth.

When a well thought out QoS scheme is applied to your network, you can then have a fluid priority control over applications and services such that the bandwidth and best ping time will be allocated to the service/application/user that you want. If you have a slower internet connection, QoS matters that much more since the bandwidth is limited.

speedtest and note down the results for your connection.

Side-note: In case you are comfortable and know what your technical skill level is, we strongly recommend you to use DD-WRT firmware for your router if it is supported. DD-WRT offers a host of various QoS settings to play with.



ENABLING QOS

QoS settings exist in almost every modern router and they can be configured by you. Considering that there are tons of different routers that everyone has and most of these routers are different in terms of their interfaces, features and capabilities, it's difficult to provide a walkthrough that fits everyone's router and/or use case. This is why we will try going through the most standard bits so that you can follow through with QoS configuration.

You'll need to navigate to your router's web-based set-



PRE-REQUISITES

Make a note of what services, applications and users you want to prioritize according to your own use case. Once you have a basic idea of what you want, it's recommended that you go ahead and stop all downloads, uploads and most major bandwidth hogging applications. This is done in order to run a speedtest to determine your average connection speed. Knowing the speed that you actually receive at your end helps when you're configuring QoS for your router. Run a



It's much more complex than that.

who are always at fault for situations like these to arise. Often, problems like this can be because of your own local network settings and they can be fixed quite easily. The nature of this month's Tips and Tricks is to get you (and your router) up to speed with something christened QoS. QoS, or Quality of Service as it's called, is an aspect of networking that deals with the overall performance of a service like a computer network as seen by the users of the network itself. Basically, using QoS it is possible for a

without much thought to what each particular application does. Let's take a short example: Say you are currently on an important Skype based interview session with a recruiter from your dream company. At the same time your girlfriend who is in the other room decides to stream 'Stranger Things' episodes on Netflix, the quality of your Skype call can suddenly take a massive hit. This is because both Skype and Netflix are trying to utilise the bandwidth while your router is trying its best to share the